

Dallas County Personal Budget and Worked Model

NAME _____ DATE _____ PERIOD _____

Dallas County One-Adult Baseline

MIT Living Wage Calculator, Dallas County, one adult/no children, updated February 15, 2026:

CATEGORY	ANNUAL BASIC EXPENSE	MONTHLY ROUNDED AMOUNT
Housing	\$17,805	\$1,484
Transportation	\$8,440	\$703
Food	\$4,019	\$335
Medical	\$3,032	\$253
Civic participation	\$2,583	\$215
Internet and mobile	\$1,454	\$121
Other basic needs	\$4,067	\$339
Total required after taxes	\$41,399	about \$3,450

Required annual income before taxes: **\$48,489**.

These are estimates for one scenario, not a family's bill or a guaranteed price. Household size, benefits, debt, savings, taxes, and personal choices change the result.

One category I need defined before budgeting:

Worked Electrician Planning Model

Fallback annual salary: \$62,350 May 2024 U.S. median.

For this classroom scenario only, use an **80% planning factor** to leave room for taxes and payroll deductions. This is not a tax calculation.

1. Estimated annual take-home for planning:

$\$62,350 \times 0.80 = \textbf{\$49,880}$

2. Estimated monthly planning income:

$\$49,880 \div 12 = \textbf{\$4,156.67}$

3. Fixed Dallas County basic-cost baseline:

$\$4,156.67 - \$3,450 = \textbf{\$706.67 remaining}$

4. Example remaining-money plan:

CHOICE	AMOUNT
Emergency savings	\$300
Long-term goal	\$200
Wants/flex	\$206.67
Total	\$706.67

One assumption that could change this model:

My Monthly Planning Income

Career and salary source: _____

Annual salary or fixed fallback amount: \$ _____

Classroom planning factor: 80%

Annual planning take-home: \$ _____ × 0.80 = \$ _____

Monthly planning income: \$ _____ ÷ 12 = \$ _____

If my source gives only a range or cannot supply one annual number, I will use the fixed fallback rather than invent a midpoint.

Explain what this planning income is—and is not:

My Basic-Needs Plan

CATEGORY	MIT BASELINE	MY AMOUNT	WHY I KEPT OR CHANGED IT
Housing	\$1,484	\$	
Transportation	\$703	\$	
Food	\$335	\$	
Medical	\$253	\$	
Civic	\$215	\$	
Internet/mobile	\$121	\$	
Other basic needs	\$339	\$	
Basic-needs total	\$3,450	\$	

One change that needs a fuller explanation:

Savings, Wants, and Balance

Monthly planning income: \$

Basic-needs total: - \$

Emergency savings: - \$

Long-term goal: - \$

Wants/flex: - \$

Final monthly balance: \$

[] surplus [] shortage [] exactly even

Why my savings and wants amounts match my stated priorities:

If the plan has a shortage, the first evidence-based revision is:

\$300 Stress Test and Revision

New monthly planning income: original \$ _____ - \$300 = \$ _____

What I would protect:

What I would reduce, delay, or replace:

Revised final balance: \$ _____

Why the revision is realistic for this fictional plan:

One factor the budget still does not include: